The Monroe Doctrine

President James Monroe · December 2, 1823

Source: James Monroe, Seventh Annual Message (1823). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> Monroe declared the Western Hemisphere closed to further European colonization and warned that any such interference would be seen as a threat — a cornerstone of U.S. foreign policy.

The political system of the allied powers is essentially different in this respect from that of America. This difference proceeds from that which exists in their respective Governments; and to the defense of our own, which has been achieved by the loss of so much blood and treasure, and matured by the wisdom of their most enlightened citizens, and under which we have enjoyed unexampled felicity, this whole nation is devoted. We owe it, therefore, to candor and to the amicable relations existing between the United States and those powers to declare that we should consider any attempt on their part to extend their system to any portion of this hemisphere as dangerous to our peace and safety.